

Chapter 69-3

Xu Qingzhu leaned back against the pillow, casually tilting her head back, her entire person appearing languid yet charming.

A moment later, Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow: "Teacher Liang, what are you thinking about?"

The suddenly ringing voice finally pulled Liang Shi's wandering thoughts back. She immediately lowered her head: "Nothing."

—How could she be so rude as to stare at someone?

—Without even thinking, she knew her expression just now must have looked very foolish.

—But Xu Qingzhu was truly beautiful, like someone who had walked out of a painting, both lively and ethereal.

Liang Shi's mind was filled with random thoughts, finally attributing this inexplicable loss of composure to—Xu Qingzhu being too beautiful.

Truly worthy of being the novel's female lead!

"What do you want to eat?" Liang Shi, afraid of being teased by Xu Qingzhu about this matter, immediately started a new topic.

Xu Qingzhu thought for a moment: "How about the snack street?"

Liang Shi: "!"

Liang Shi had only seen the so-called "snack street" during filming.

Every city has a "snack street," which can be large or small. Some are a city's food collection, some are "food anthologies" from various places.

The slightly better-developed ones would become a city's check-in spot¹.

Dozens of roadside stalls set up together, with all sorts of fragrances floating in the air.

The street lights were bright, but they seemed less bright when they fell on the stalls. Each stall would have its own lights.

An entire street was an extremely lively place filled with the aroma of everyday life².

The original host probably had never been there even once.

Liang Shi was also quite surprised that Xu Qingzhu even knew about such a place.

After all, these were "slum delicacies³."

And after getting in the car, Xu Qingzhu directly told the navigation the destination—Qingyi University's South Gate Two.

Xu Qingzhu sat in the passenger seat. Although her emotions were still slightly low, they weren't as gloomy as when she had just woken up.

After the car had driven for a stretch, Xu Qingzhu suddenly said: "Teacher Liang, thank you."

Liang Shi was confused: "For what?"

"I don't know." Xu Qingzhu said: "Anyway, thank you."

Liang Shi: "...Okay."

"So as thanks, tonight I'm treating you to the super invincible devil spicy set meal at our school's entrance." Xu Qingzhu said: "I dare say, in all of Haizhou City, there isn't a single shop whose hot and sour noodles⁴ can compare to the spiciness of theirs."

Liang Shi: "?"

She was shocked, yet also very considerately answered: "Okay."

"There's also takoyaki⁵ and beef buns." Xu Qingzhu said: "If you have a big appetite, I can also treat you to fried chicken."

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi couldn't help but glance at Xu Qingzhu with her peripheral vision. She saw that when she spoke about these dishes, there were stars in her eyes.

It was an expression of great anticipation.

Suddenly, for that one instant, she no longer felt that Xu Qingzhu was an unattainable fairy.

It was as if she were simply the girl next door, or a cute junior from school, introducing her favorite foods to her like precious treasures.

"Your school? It's also Sally and Lin Luoxi's school, right?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu nodded, then touched her phone screen and suddenly asked: "Do you mind eating together?"

"Eating what?" Liang Shi asked.

"Dinner." Xu Qingzhu had already unlocked her screen. "I'll call Sally and Cherry over, and we can eat dinner together."

Liang Shi nodded: "I don't mind."

With more people, it would be livelier. Once it became lively, the sadness would be diluted.

Liang Shi naturally wouldn't mind.

¹ Check-in spot (打卡地) - A popular term in Chinese social media culture referring to trendy locations where people go to take photos and "check in" on social media platforms.

² Aroma of everyday life (煙火氣) - Literally "smoke and fire energy," this Chinese expression refers to the warm, bustling atmosphere of everyday life, particularly associated with cooking, eating, and the vibrancy of common people's lives. It conveys a sense of down-to-earth authenticity and human warmth.

³ Slum delicacies (貧民窟美食) - A somewhat humorous/ironic term referring to inexpensive street food or hole-in-the-wall eateries that are delicious but not fancy or expensive, implying these are foods the wealthy elite might look down upon.

⁴ Hot and sour noodles (酸辣粉) - A popular Sichuan street food consisting of sweet potato noodles in a spicy and tangy broth, typically garnished with peanuts, preserved vegetables, and chili oil.

⁵ Takoyaki (章魚小丸子) - Literally "octopus little balls," a popular Japanese street food that has become widespread in China, consisting of ball-shaped snacks made of wheat flour batter filled with pieces of octopus.